

Red chile roasted tomato rice

This rich red rice is **perfect** with Mexican Marinated Tofu (page 134). The two chiles I recommend here are mild to medium on the heat scale. Top with avocado slices or chopped scallions.

2 guajillo or red New Mexico chiles, seeded and stemmed*

½ pound plum tomatoes [250g]

3 garlic cloves, unpeeled

1 teaspoon unrefined cane sugar

1 teaspoon salt

½ white onion, cut into small dice

1 tablespoon olive oil

1 cup brown jasmine or other long-grain brown rice [200g]

2½ cups stock or water [625g]

½ cup frozen peas [60g]

1. In a small covered bowl or large covered glass, **soak** the chiles in very hot water until soft.
2. Preheat the broiler with a rack set 4 to 6 inches [10 to 15cm] from the heat. Lay out the tomatoes on a baking pan and broil until they are lightly blackened and softened and the skins are popping off, 5 to 7 minutes per side. **Turn** with tongs. Let cool, remove the skins, and set the tomatoes aside in a bowl with their juices.
3. While the tomatoes are broiling, in a cast-iron skillet over medium heat, **roast** the unpeeled garlic. Turn over with tongs occasionally but allow to get slightly blackened, 10 to 15 minutes. When cooled, peel and chop the garlic and add to the bowl with the tomatoes.
4. In a blender, puree the softened chiles, tomatoes, garlic, sugar, and salt. **Pour** the sauce back into the bowl.

*When the chiles have softened, taste the soaking water. If it is not bitter, substitute ½ cup [125ml] for ½ cup [125ml] stock.

5. In a saucepan, **cook** the onion in the olive oil over medium heat until very soft, 3 to 4 minutes. Add the rice and stir continuously for about 1 minute. Turn up the heat to high and add the tomato-chile sauce (it should sizzle); stir for about 30 seconds. Add the stock and bring to a boil. Cover, reduce to a simmer, and cook for 45 minutes, or until tender.
6. **Stir** in the peas. Remove from heat and let stand, covered, for 10 minutes before serving.

SERVES 4

note If the rice is not done but the liquid has evaporated, add $\frac{1}{4}$ cup [60ml] more boiling water and continue to cook. Repeat if necessary.

